Automate the ticket, not the team

What Klarna's reversal teaches every support leader

01

Klarna cut 700 agents

Cost fell. Quality fell faster. In 2025 the CEO admitted it and started rehiring humans.

02

The mistake is the unit

They automated headcount. The unit of automation is a ticket type, not a person.

03

Let AI close the boring 70%

Order status, warranty proof, password resets, invoice copies. Predictable, repetitive, measurable.

04

Keep humans for the hard 30%

Refund exceptions, angry VIPs, legal. One sharp human here beats five on easy tickets.

05

Measure resolution, not deflection

"Was it solved" is the metric. Deflection just hides the ticket until it comes back angrier.

Comment "audit" for the 5-step checklist

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